BCSE CLASS X
ENGLISH II

Literature — Short Stories, Essay, Poetry & Novel

Exam notes with solved papers — BCSE **2024** and **2025** English II

Stories: *The Bet*, *The White Knight*, *The Imp and the Crust* · Essays: *The Titanic*, *A Brief History of Chocolate* · Poems: *Good Timber*, *To My Mother* · Novel: *The Giver*

How to use these notes

Every chapter has (1) a **summary table** of the text, (2) **diagrams** (plot, timeline, comparison), (3) **exam link** showing where the text was asked, and (4) **solved questions** with model answers. Answers are shown in **green underlined bold** (MCQs) or in boxed model paragraphs. Word counts are shown so you can see what 60 and 150 words look like.

Important

The plot details were built from the exam questions and standard summaries of each text. Cross-check names, dates and small details with **your own textbook** before the exam, and note that the stories and poems set in your exam may be different from the ones in the 2024/2025 papers — the *method* in these notes works for any text.

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Printing tip

Print double-sided on A4. Every chapter starts on a new page, so you can compile and re-arrange chapters in a file.

Chapter 1: Paper Pattern & How to Answer

English II — four sections, 25 marks each

1.1 Structure of the paper (same in 2024 and 2025)

Section	Q1 (compulsory) — 15 marks	Q2 (choose a OR b) — 10 marks
A: Short Story [25]	(a) 5 MCQs [5] • (b)(i) 60-word answer [5] • (b)(ii) 60-word answer [5]	150 words
B: Essay [25]	Read an unseen essay: 5 MCQs, two 60-word answers	150 words (rewrite / report / compare)
C: Poetry [25]	Printed poem: 5 MCQs, two 60-word answers	150 words
D: Novel [25]	5 MCQs, two 60-word answers	150 words

Texts asked

Section	2024	2025
A Short story	*The Bet* (Anton Chekhov) — Q2(a) also uses *The White Knight*	*The White Knight* (Eric Nicol) **and** *The Imp and the Crust* (Leo Tolstoy)
B Essay	*The Titanic – History of a Disaster* (adapted from NOAA)	A brief history of chocolate (adapted from the Smithsonian Magazine)
C Poetry	*Good Timber* (Douglas Malloch)	*To My Mother* (George Barker)
D Novel	*The Giver* (Lois Lowry)	*The Giver* (Lois Lowry)

> **Key observation**
> Section B is an **unseen-type passage** (a different essay every year) — so you are tested on **reading skills and essay features**, not memory. Sections A, C and D test the prescribed texts: the novel *The Giver* appears every year, and a story, a poem and an essay change.

1.2 Question types and how to answer them

Type	Length	Strategy
MCQ	1 mark each	Read the question twice; eliminate two options; choose the **best** answer (e.g. EXCEPT questions); circle only ONE letter.
Short answer	about 60 words (5 marks)	Use **PEEL**: Point → Evidence from the text → Explain → Link. If it says "TWO reasons", give exactly two, each with its own evidence.
Long answer	about 150 words (10 marks)	1 line introduction → 2–3 clear points, each with an example/quote → 1 line conclusion. Cover every part of the question (e.g. "THREE benefits", "FOUR features").
Creative / opinion	60–150 words	Stay in character/format (advertisement, report, continuation). Link your ideas to the text.

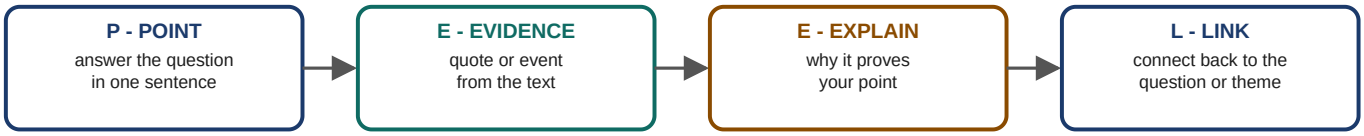


Fig 1.1 PEEL - the 60-word answer formula

Command word	What the examiner wants
Explain	give reasons / make clear how or why
Justify / Defend	give reasons and evidence to support a statement
Contrast	show the **differences** between two things (use *whereas, however, in contrast*)
Compare	show similarities and differences
Outline	give the main events/points briefly, in order
Discuss / Give your opinion	present your view with reasons from the text
Imagine / Compose / Write a continuation	creative writing that stays logical and linked to the story
List and explain	name the points first, then explain each

Marks strategy

Each 60-word answer = 5 marks → about **2 clear points** with evidence. Each 150-word answer = 10 marks → about **3 points** with evidence. Write in the **present tense** for literature (*The lawyer renounces the money*), use character names, and never retell the whole story.

Chapter 2: The Bet — Anton Chekhov

Section A · asked in 2024 (Q1 and Q2) · Russian short story (1889)

2.1 Must-know summary

Element	Details
Author & genre	Anton Chekhov (Russian writer, 1860–1904). A short story with a **moral and psychological** focus.
Setting	A dark, windy **autumn night** in the banker's house; the story looks back fifteen years to a party in the same house. The lawyer is confined in a lodge in the banker's garden.
Narration	Third person. Begins in the **present** (the last night) and then goes back in a **flashback** to the party fifteen years earlier.
Main characters	**The banker** — rich, proud, spoilt and frivolous; later ruined and desperate. **The young lawyer** — 25 at the start, intelligent, idealistic, determined; changes into a wise man who despises wealth. Minor: guests, the watchman, servant.
The bet	At a party the guests argue about **capital punishment vs life imprisonment**. The banker says death is more humane; the lawyer says "to live in any way is better than not at all". The banker bets **two million** that the lawyer cannot bear solitary confinement for **fifteen years**.
Rules	The lawyer stays alone in the lodge, may not see or speak to anyone, may send notes and ask for books, music, wine. If he leaves even a few minutes early, the banker is free from paying.
Plot in brief	First years: the lawyer suffers, reads light novels, plays the piano. Later he studies languages, philosophy and history; then the Gospels, theology, science and poetry. Meanwhile the banker loses his fortune by gambling and speculation. On the last night he plans to kill the lawyer to avoid paying, finds him asleep and reads his letter: the lawyer **despises** money and all worldly things and will **leave five minutes early** to forfeit the prize. The banker kisses him and weeps, feeling great contempt for himself. Next morning the watchman reports the lawyer has fled; the banker locks the letter in his safe.
Themes	greed and the corrupting power of money • true value of knowledge • moral transformation • capital punishment / value of life • freedom vs imprisonment (the banker is the real prisoner of money) • pride and shame.
Literary devices	**Flashback** (opening), **irony** (the "prisoner" wins; the rich man loses), **contrast / foil** (banker vs lawyer), **symbolism** (the lodge = isolation, books = knowledge, the safe = greed), **suspense** (the night, the planned murder), **foreshadowing** (the banker's growing money worries).
Moral	Material wealth is worthless compared with wisdom, self-control and freedom of mind.

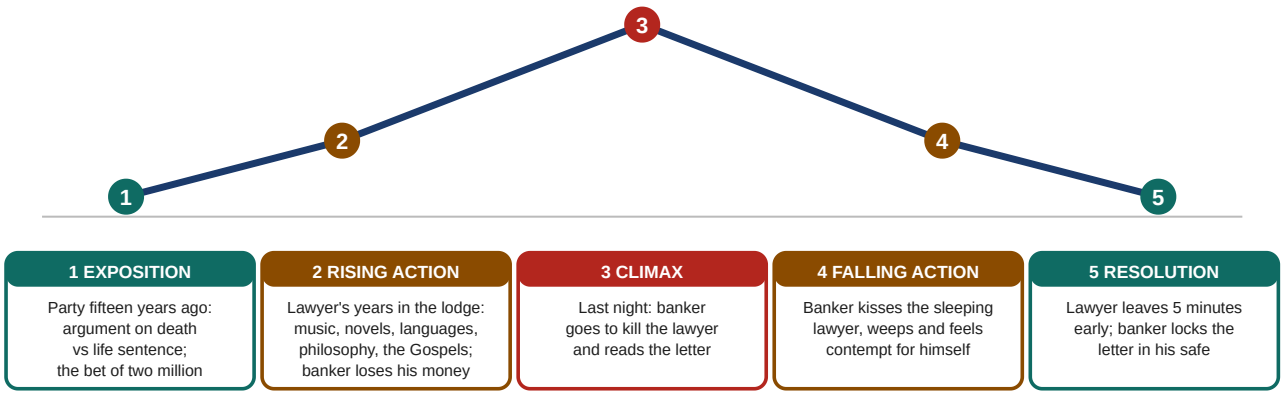


Fig 2.1 Plot diagram of The Bet

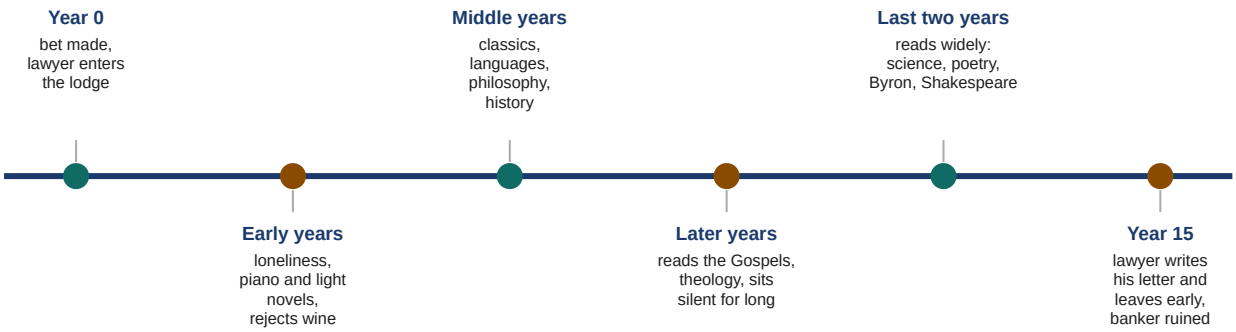


Fig 2.2 The lawyer's fifteen years and the banker's fall

BANKER		LAWYER
Begins rich, proud, frivolous	→	Begins young, idealistic, sure he can survive
Believes death is kinder than prison	→	Believes any life is better than death
Gambles and speculates, loses wealth	→	Reads, learns, grows wise
Plans to murder the lawyer to save money	→	Comes to despise money and worldly things
Reads the letter, feels shame and weeps	→	Renounces the money and leaves early

Fig 2.3 The banker and the lawyer: how they change

2.2 Exam link

Question	Type	Topic
2024 A-Q1(a)	5 MCQs	lawyer's time in confinement; flashback; *reckoning*; theme; banker's attitude
2024 A-Q1(b)(i)	60 words	Why the lawyer renounced the money (TWO reasons)
2024 A-Q1(b)(ii)	60 words	Who is the eventual winner? (TWO reasons)
2024 A-Q2(a)	150 words	Contrast the banker and the White Knight — events that change them
2024 A-Q2(b)	150 words	A book you have read and how it changed your thoughts and actions

2.3 Solved questions

2024 A-Q1(a) Multiple-choice questions [5]

No.	Question	Answer	Reason
i	The lawyer spends his time during his confinement by…	**A**	studying and reading extensively — languages, philosophy, history, science, the Gospels
ii	The story begins with an/a…	**C flashback**	It opens on the last night and then goes back fifteen years to the party
iii	"millions beyond his reckoning" — the underlined word means…	**A figuring**	*reckoning* = calculation/counting: so rich that he could not count his money
iv	The story explores the theme of…	**B**	corrupting influence of power and wealth (greed ruins the banker; the lawyer rejects wealth)
v	The banker's attitude at the end of fifteen years…	**D**	He regrets the bet and wants to escape paying — he even plans to kill the lawyer

2024 A-Q1(b)(i) People, in general, are after money. Then what made the lawyer renounce his bet of two millions at the end? Explain with TWO reasons. [5]

The lawyer renounced the two million because fifteen years of reading changed his values. Firstly, his study of books, philosophy and religion taught him that wealth, pleasure and even human wisdom are temporary and empty, so money lost its attraction. Secondly, he wanted to show his complete contempt for the banker's greed, so he left five minutes before the deadline and deliberately forfeited the prize.

≈ 65 words

2024 A-Q1(b)(ii) Who do you think is the eventual winner in The Bet? Justify with TWO reasons. [5]

In my opinion, the lawyer is the eventual winner. Firstly, he survives fifteen years of solitude and emerges wiser and free from greed and pride, which is a greater victory than money. Secondly, he voluntarily gives up the two million, showing great moral strength, whereas the banker, ruined and ashamed after planning a murder, loses his dignity.

≈ 57 words

2024 A-Q2(a) Contrast the banker in The Bet and the White Knight in The White Knight by outlining the events in their respective lives that change them. [10]

The banker in The Bet and the White Knight both begin with false confidence, but different events change them.

At the start the banker is rich, proud and frivolous, and he makes the bet carelessly. Over fifteen years he gambles and speculates and loses his fortune, so on the last night he plans to kill the lawyer to avoid paying. After reading the lawyer's letter of contempt for money, however, he is ashamed, kisses the sleeping lawyer and weeps.

The White Knight begins as a self-righteous man who sees himself as the symbol of good and rides out to destroy the Black Knight. Always arriving too late, he grows hungry and desperate, steals buns and a horse, and finally kills an innocent youth. Seeing his armour turned black, he realises that he has become the evil he hunted.

Thus the banker is changed by shame, while the knight is changed by shock.

≈ 152 words

2024 A-Q2(b) The lawyer undergoes a transformation by reading different books. Name a book you have read and explain how it changed your thoughts and actions. [10]

The lawyer in The Bet changes from a young man who wanted to win an argument into a wise man who despises wealth, because books opened his mind. A book that changed me is *Wings of Fire*, the autobiography of A. P. J.

Abdul Kalam.

Before reading it, I gave up quickly whenever a task was difficult, and I believed that success belonged only to the rich or the lucky. Kalam grew up in a modest family, sold newspapers as a boy and missed his dream of becoming a fighter pilot, yet he never stopped working and became a great scientist and President. His life taught me that perseverance matters more than circumstances.

After reading the book, I set clear goals, made a daily study timetable and began to treat failures as lessons. I also started helping my juniors with their studies, as Kalam believed in sharing knowledge. Like the lawyer, I learned that a good book can change a person.

≈ 161 words

Choose your own book

You may name any book you have really read. Use this pattern: **link to the lawyer → name the book + one fact → my thoughts before → what changed in my actions**.

Chapter 3: The White Knight — Eric Nicol

Section A · asked in 2025 (Q1, Q2) and 2024 (Q2a) · a modern fairy-tale allegory

3.1 Must-know summary

Element	Details
Author & genre	Eric Nicol (Canadian humorist and writer). A short **allegory / satirical fairy tale** (it opens "Once upon a time there was a knight…").
Setting	A little castle at the edge of the **forest of Life**; villages, an inn, a baker's shop and the forest where the knight travels — a symbolic world.
Characters	**The White Knight** — proud, self-righteous, sure that he stands for good. **The Black Knight** — the evil he hunts; never seen. **The young knight in shining white armour** — the innocent youth. Villagers: baker, innkeeper and daughter.
Plot	(1) The knight looks into a mirror, sees a White Knight and decides to find and kill the **Black Knight** (evil) in single combat. (2) Rides off but is always **too late**: the baker's shop robbed, a horse stolen, the innkeeper's daughter wronged. (3) Tired, hungry and short of money, he **steals buns**, swaps his lame horse for another at night; his armour is stained by the long quest. (4) In the forest a youth in gleaming white armour charges him; the knight **kills** him. (5) The dying youth asks whether evil has won; the knight sees his own darkened armour **black** beside the youth's brightness and realises **he has become the Black Knight**.
Themes	appearance vs reality • self-deception • self-righteousness is dangerous • good and evil exist within one person • heroism is judged by **actions, not by looks or intentions** • the need for self-awareness.
Symbols	mirror = self-image/vanity • white armour = claimed goodness • black armour = hidden guilt • Black Knight = evil/the shadow in ourselves • forest of Life = life's journey • the quest = the search for evil outside while ignoring one's own faults.
Devices	**Irony** (he hunts evil and becomes it), **allegory**, **symbolism**, **satire**, fairy-tale opening, third-person narration.
Moral	Do not trust appearances or your own self-image; check your actions. People who are sure they are right can do great harm.

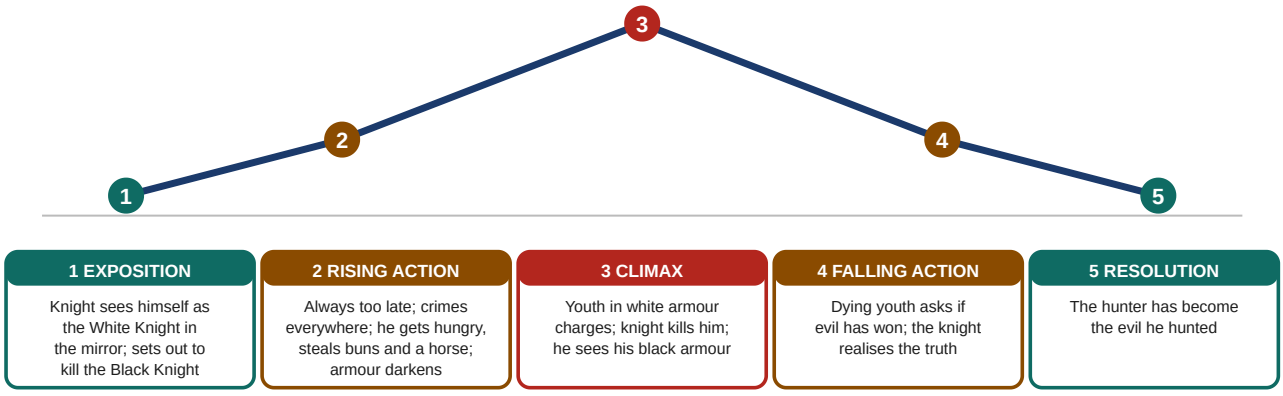


Fig 3.1 Plot diagram of The White Knight

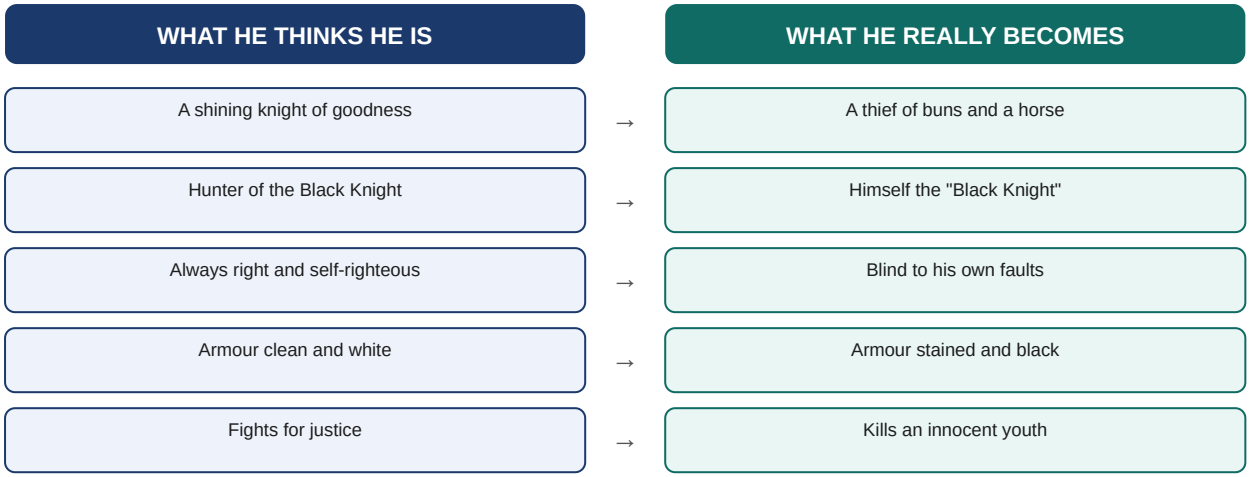


Fig 3.2 Self-image vs reality of the White Knight

> **Check with your textbook**
> The summary above follows standard study guides of the story. Your textbook version may use slightly different details (the order of crimes, the closing lines). Always quote or refer to events from **your** copy.

3.2 Exam link

Question	Type	Topic
2025 A-Q1(a)(i, iv)	MCQ	the initial quest; lessons of the story (EXCEPT)
2025 A-Q1(b)(i)	60 words	"Appearances can be misleading" — justify
2025 A-Q2(a)	150 words	Transformation of the peasant (Imp) and the knight
2024 A-Q2(a)	150 words	Contrast the banker (The Bet) with the White Knight

3.3 Solved questions

2025 A-Q1(a) MCQs on The White Knight

No.	Question	Answer	Reason
i	The initial quest of the White Knight is to…	C	defeat the Black Knight (the embodiment of evil)
iv	All are lessons of The White Knight EXCEPT…	C	"the pursuit of material wealth" is not the lesson; the story teaches that appearances deceive (A), true heroism lies in actions (B), and self-righteousness is dangerous (D)

2025 A-Q1(b)(i) The White Knight teaches us that appearances can be misleading. Justify the statement with reference to the story. [5]

The White Knight shows that appearances can mislead. The knight looks shining and heroic in his white armour and believes that he stands for goodness, yet his actions are wrong: he steals buns, takes another's horse and kills an innocent youth. His armour turns black, while the youth who looks pure is truly innocent. Thus outward whiteness hides the knight's real nature.

≈ 62 words

Chapter 4: The Imp and the Crust — Leo Tolstoy

Section A · asked in 2025 (Q1 and Q2) · a moral folk tale (1886)

4.1 Must-know summary

Element	Details
Author & genre	Leo Tolstoy (Russian novelist, 1828–1910). A **moral folk tale / fable** with devils and a simple peasant.
Setting	A Russian village — the peasant's field, then his farm and house.
Characters	**The poor peasant** — hard-working, kind, forgiving. **The imp** — a little devil sent to tempt him. **The Devil** (chief devil) — the imp's master. Neighbours and a poor man at the feast.
Plot	(1) A poor peasant goes to plough, wraps his bread in his coat and hides it under a bush. The **imp steals the bread** and waits behind the bush to hear him curse. (2) The peasant, hungry, says that whoever took it **must have needed it — "may it do him good"**; he feels no anger, so the imp fails. (3) The Devil threatens the imp that if he cannot win the peasant in **three years**, he will be ducked in holy water. (4) The imp comes back as a **hired labourer** and gives clever advice that brings the peasant a **huge harvest**, even in a bad year. (5) With the surplus grain the imp teaches him to make **vodka**. (6) The peasant grows rich, proud and greedy, and drinks. He becomes **miserly, bullying and finally brutal**. (7) At a drunken **party** he refuses a poor man a drink ("I can't find drink for everyone who comes along"). (8) The imp reports his success; the **Devil praises and rewards him**.
Title	**The crust** stands for the peasant's early simple life and generosity — he could forgive the theft of his last crust and think of the thief's need; it is also the first test the imp fails. By the end the peasant refuses even a drink to the poor.
Themes	wealth and greed corrupt • temptation • kindness and forgiveness vs anger • alcohol and vice destroy character • simplicity and sharing are true goodness.
Devices	**Dramatic irony** (the reader knows the labourer is the imp), **symbolism** (crust = simple life/sharing; vodka = vice; imp = temptation), **personification** of evil, **contrast** (the peasant before and after wealth), a fable's **moral**.
Moral	A man is tested not by poverty but by wealth. Easy riches and bad habits can destroy goodness more surely than hardship.

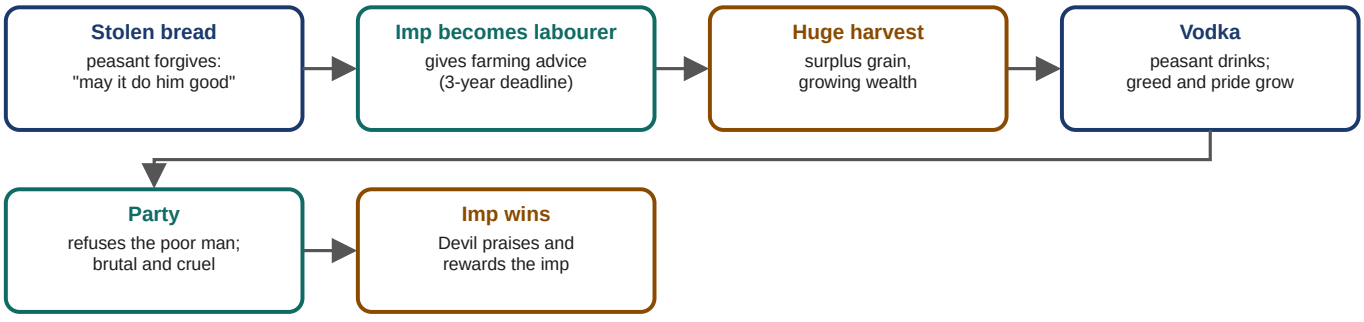


Fig 4.1 The peasant's decline - the imp's temptation ladder

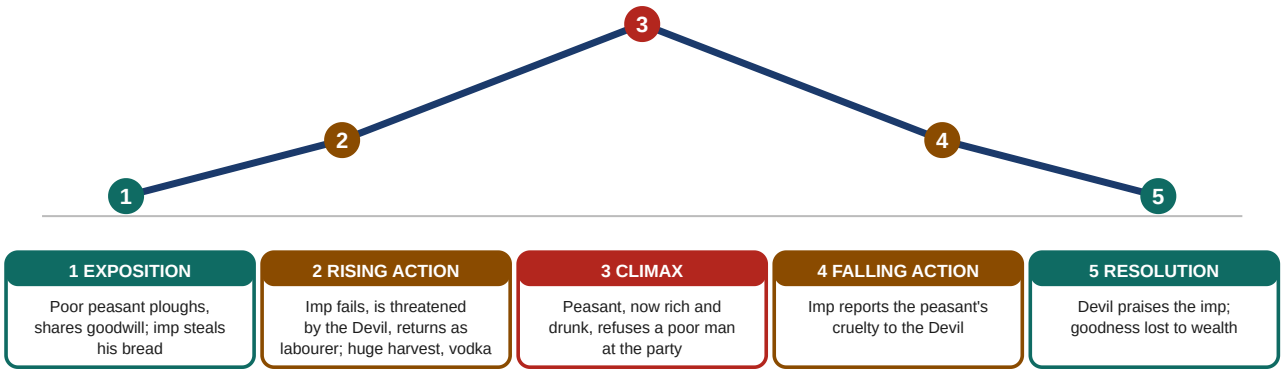


Fig 4.2 Plot diagram of The Imp and the Crust

Check with your textbook

Details of the middle of the story (the exact advice the imp gives and the order of events at the party) can differ between translations. Use the events above and add small details from your own copy.

4.2 Exam link

Question	Type	Topic
2025 A-Q1(a)(ii, iii, v)	MCQ	meaning of "the crust"; why the imp steals the bread; the peasant's reaction
2025 A-Q1(b)(ii)	60 words	Write a logical continuation of the ending (after the party)
2025 A-Q2(a)	150 words	Peasant and knight: transformation of two "good" characters
2025 A-Q2(b)	150 words	Imagine you are the imp: TWO alternative strategies

4.3 Solved questions

2025 A-Q1(a) MCQs on The Imp and the Crust

No.	Question	Answer	Reason
ii	In the title, "the crust" signifies…	D	the importance of sharing food with those in need — the peasant's first reaction to the theft is concern for the hungry thief. (A "a simple life lived with gratitude" is also close, but D follows the peasant's words and the later contrast.)
iii	The imp steals the bread to make the peasant feel…	D	angry and vengeful towards the doer — the imp wants to hear him curse
v	The peasant's reaction to the stolen bread reveals his…	A	faith and trust in the goodness of others — he believes the thief needed it and wishes him well

2025 A-Q1(b)(ii) Write a short logical continuation (about 60 words) to show what happens to the peasant after the party. [5]

The next morning the peasant woke with a heavy head and looked around his house: broken jugs, torn clothes and quarrelling guests. He remembered the poor man he had refused and felt deeply ashamed. He poured the remaining vodka onto the ground, shared his surplus grain with hungry neighbours and returned to ploughing. Once again he lived simply, content with whatever the earth gave him.

≈ 65 words

(Another logical ending: he continues drinking, loses his money and ends up poorer than before. Either is accepted if it fits his character and the moral.)

2025 A-Q2(a) Both the poor peasant in The Imp and the Crust and the knight in The White Knight are initially presented as having positive qualities. Using details from the stories, explain how their characters get transformed. [10]

Both the peasant and the knight begin as admirable men, but each is transformed for the worse.

In The Imp and the Crust the peasant is hard-working, kind and forgiving. When the imp steals his bread, he says that the thief must have needed it. After the imp's clever advice brings him a huge harvest, he makes vodka from the surplus grain. Wealth and drink make him proud, greedy and cruel, and at the party he refuses even a drink to a poor man.

The White Knight begins as a brave, idealistic man who believes that he stands for good and sets out to kill the Black Knight. Failure and hunger drive him to steal buns and a horse, and finally he kills an innocent youth. His blackened armour shows that he has become the evil he hunted.

Thus the peasant is corrupted by temptation and wealth, while the knight is corrupted by his own self-righteousness.

≈ 156 words

2025 A-Q2(b) Imagine you are the imp and are frustrated by your initial failure with the peasant. Considering the peasant's character and the innate human weaknesses, explain TWO alternative strategies (other than those in the text) to tempt him into sin. [10]

I am furious that the peasant forgave me, but I know that every human has a weakness. Since he is kind and trusting, I shall use two new strategies.

First, I shall use pride. I shall make the villagers praise him as the wisest and most generous man in the area. Humans love flattery, so he will soon begin to think that he is better than his neighbours. His pride will make him look down on the poor, and a proud man cannot easily forgive or help others.

Second, I shall use jealousy. I shall arrange for his neighbour to buy a finer ox and build a bigger house. When the peasant compares himself with the neighbour, he will begin to envy him. Envy will turn into anger, then into quarrels and revenge.

Once he is proud and jealous, the peasant's gentle heart will be lost and I shall be rewarded.

≈ 151 words

Chapter 5: Essay — The Titanic: History of a Disaster

Section B · asked in 2024 · expository essay, chronological narration

5.1 Must-know summary of the passage

Aspect	Details from the passage
Genre & purpose	Informative / **expository** essay (adapted from the NOAA website). It explains what happened and why it matters.
Text type & order	**Chronological narration** — events in time order (warnings → collision → lifeboats → panic → sinking → rescue → impact).
Thesis (main idea)	The Titanic disaster was largely a result of **human error and arrogance** — ignored or unclear warnings and **too few lifeboats** — and it led to major changes in maritime safety.
Key facts	British luxury liner, **maiden voyage**, sank on **14 April 1912** with **2240** passengers and crew. Many iceberg warnings; unclear if they reached the control room. Designed for about **3500** people but had lifeboats for about **1200**. Captain: **Edward John Smith**.
Events	About **12:30 a.m.**: only women and children to the lifeboats • **1:30 a.m.**: panic; on the port side passengers threatened to jump into a lifeboat meant for 65 but holding 28; an officer **fired three shots** to scare them • the last lifeboat had 47 spaces: crew formed a **circle** and only women and children passed • more than **1500** still on board when the stern lifted • **2:20 a.m.**: the ship stood upright, then sank • **RMS Carpathia** arrived about two hours later and rescued **700+**.
Expert view	Walter Lord (*The Night Lives On*): if First Officer Murdoch had steamed **right at** the iceberg instead of trying to avoid it, he might have saved the ship.
Impact	New maritime laws: **enough lifeboats**, improved safety procedures, an **international ice patrol**. The tragedy became a symbol of **human hubris** (excessive pride) and the cost of ignoring safety.
Human dramas	Men saw off wives and children; families separated; selfless people gave up their seats for the vulnerable.

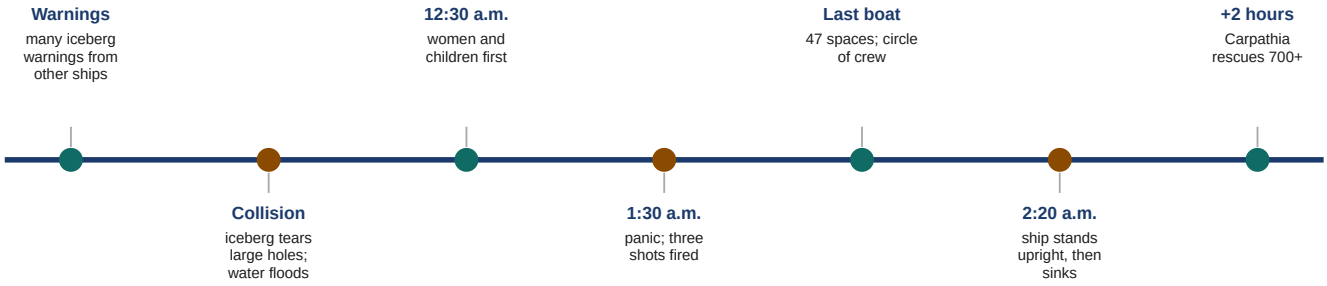


Fig 5.1 Timeline of the sinking (as given in the passage)

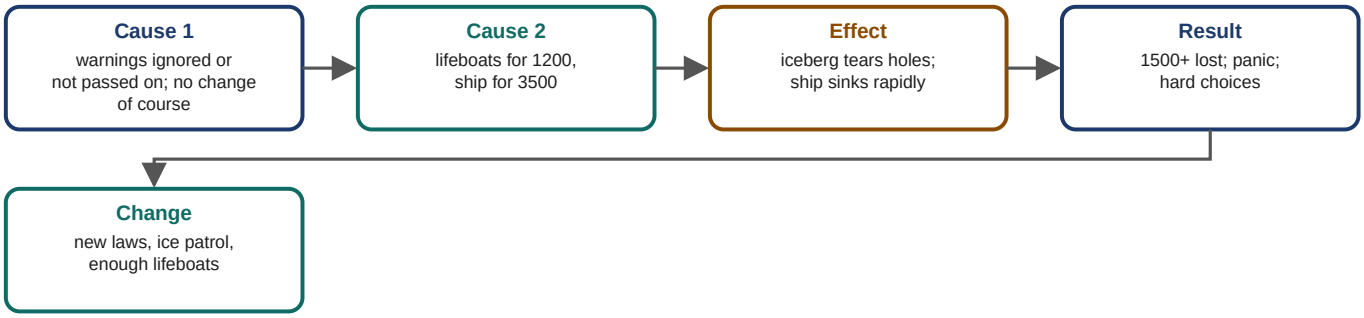


Fig 5.2 Cause and effect in the Titanic disaster

Essay features tested (use for MCQs)

Feature	In the Titanic essay
Introduction / thesis	Paragraph 1 gives the date, the ship and the main idea: warnings and the shortage of lifeboats.
Body paragraphs	Paragraph 2–3: warnings/collision and lifeboats; paragraph 4: climax at 2:20 a.m.; paragraph 5: rescue.
Supporting evidence	Numbers (2240, 3500, 1200, 65/28, 47), times, and the expert quotation by Walter Lord.
Conclusion	Last paragraph: impact on maritime regulations; symbol of human hubris.
Vocabulary	**climactic** = relating to the climax, the final/most intense moment; **hubris** = excessive pride; **exacerbating** = making worse; **maiden voyage** = first journey.

5.2 Solved questions

2024 B-Q1(a) MCQs [5]

No.	Question	Answer	Reason
i	The word 'climactic' (paragraph 4) means…	**B final**	"The climactic moment came at 2:20 a.m." = the most intense, final moment
ii	The reason for firing three shots was to…	**D**	threaten the panicking people — the officer fired "to scare them"
iii	Which phrase would best be part of the thesis statement?	**C**	"limited numbers of lifeboats on board" — the main cause that runs through the essay; A and D are not supported, B is a detail
iv	Titanic's disaster was…	**A**	a result of human error — ignored warnings, too few lifeboats, "human hubris"
v	The crew formed a circle because they wanted to…	**A**	select who should go first — only women and children were allowed through the circle

2024 B-Q1(b)(i) The story of the Titanic is often seen as a cautionary tale about human arrogance and the consequences of disregarding safety measures. Explain briefly. [5]

The Titanic is a warning against arrogance. The crew received several iceberg warnings, yet the ship did not slow down or change course, as if nothing could harm it. The ship also carried lifeboats for only about 1200 of the 3500 people it could hold. This careless attitude cost more than 1500 lives and later forced the world to make stricter safety laws.

≈ 63 words

2024 B-Q1(b)(ii) Give your opinion on why the sinking of the Titanic still continues to captivate people's interest and imagination even after a century. [5]

In my opinion, the Titanic still fascinates people for two reasons. First, it combines luxury, ambition and a preventable tragedy: the greatest ship of its time sank on its first voyage. Second, it contains powerful human stories, such as husbands saying goodbye to families and people giving up their seats, which touch our emotions. The unanswered question of whether the warnings reached the control room adds mystery.

≈ 67 words

2024 B-Q2(a) The text uses chronological narration. Rewrite the essay in a paragraph using cause and effect narration. [10]

Method: start from the **cause**, link with *because, as a result, therefore, consequently, this led to*, end with the **effects**.

The Titanic sank mainly because warnings were ignored and safety was neglected. Several ships sent iceberg warnings, but it is uncertain whether they reached the control room, and the ship did not change its course in time. As a result, the iceberg tore large holes in the hull, and water flooded several compartments, so the ship began to sink rapidly. Because the Titanic carried lifeboats for only about 1200 of the 3500 people it could hold, there were not enough places for everyone. Consequently, the captain ordered women and children to be loaded first, and panic broke out among the passengers; an officer even fired three shots to control the crowd. Because there were too few lifeboats, and some left half empty, more than 1500 people were still on board when the ship stood upright at 2:20 a.m. and went down. This tragedy led to new laws that require enough lifeboats, better safety procedures and an international ice patrol.

≈ 161 words

2024 B-Q2(b) You are Wilson, a reporter from BBC, who is among the survivors of the Titanic tragedy. Write a report on the sinking of Titanic. [10]

Titanic Sinks on Her Maiden Voyage

By Wilson, BBC (survivor and eyewitness)

On board RMS Carpathia, 15 April 1912: The luxury liner Titanic sank in the north Atlantic after striking an iceberg on her maiden voyage, and more than 1500 people were lost. I was among about 700 survivors who were rescued.

The iceberg tore large holes in the ship's hull and water flooded several compartments. Although many warnings had been received that night, the ship did not avoid the ice. Around 12:30 a.m. the officers ordered women and children into the lifeboats. There were boats for only about 1200 of the 3500 people the ship could carry. By 1:30 a.m. there was panic, and an officer fired three shots to calm the crowd. At 2:20 a.m. the ship stood upright and disappeared. The Carpathia reached us about two hours later.

Many men stayed behind so that their wives and children could escape. Officials say that stricter safety rules must now follow.

≈ 162 words

Chapter 6: Essay — A Brief History of Chocolate

Section B · asked in 2025 · expository essay, adapted from the Smithsonian Magazine

6.1 Must-know summary of the passage

Aspect	Details from the passage
Genre & purpose	**Expository** (informative) essay: it explains the history, meaning and economic importance of chocolate. (It is neither narrative nor argumentative.)
Main idea	Chocolate is "the best-known food that nobody knows anything about" (Alexandra Leaf): for about **90%** of its history it was a **bitter drink**, not a sweet bar, and it has been valued as **currency** and a global industry.
Terms	**cacao** = the plant/beans before processing • **chocolate** = anything made from the beans • **cocoa** = the powdered form. Origin of the word: Aztec **xocoatl** (bitter drink). Latin name *Theobroma cacao* = "**food of the gods**".
Early history	Around for about 2000 years (maybe longer). In pre-modern Latin America beans were **currency**: **1 bean = a tamale; 100 beans = a good turkey hen**.
Europe	Montezuma welcomed Cortes with a banquet, mistaking him for a returning deity. Spaniards first disliked the drink ("a bitter drink for pigs") but, mixed with **honey or cane sugar**, it became popular in Spain; by the **17th century** a fashionable drink for the rich (Casanova liked it).
Industrial age	The **steam engine** (late 1700s) made **mass production** possible. **1828**: a Dutch chemist made powdered "Dutch cocoa". **1847**: **Joseph Fry** made the first modern chocolate bar. **1868**: **Cadbury** sold boxed chocolates. Later **milk chocolate** by **Nestlé**.
America	Chocolate was in soldiers' rations (and used in lieu of wages) in the Revolutionary War. Today a **more than $4 billion** industry in the US; the average American eats about half a pound a month.

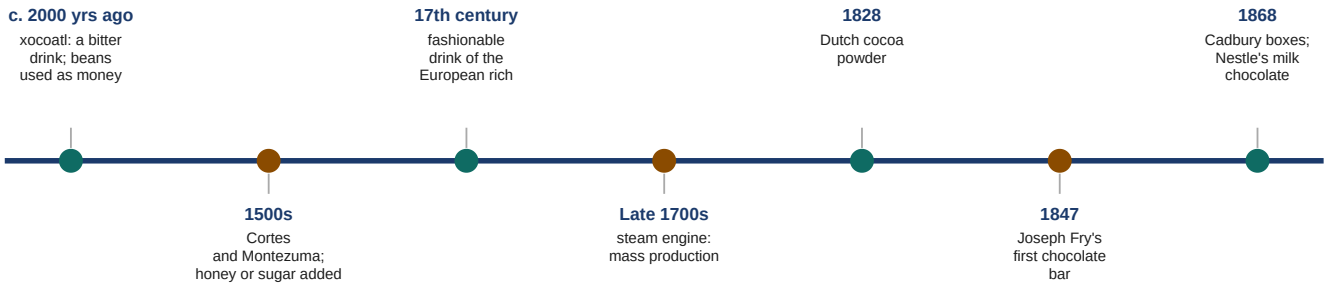


Fig 6.1 History of chocolate

Useful vocabulary	Meaning
in lieu of	instead of; as a substitute for
etymologists	experts who study the origin of words
reincarnated deity	a god come back to life
aphrodisiac	something believed to increase love/desire
humble	modest, ordinary

6.2 Solved questions

2025 B-Q1(a) **MCQs [5]**

No.	Question	Answer	Reason
i	The Aztec word for the bitter chocolate drink is…	**B xocoatl**	"referred to a bitter drink brewed from cacao beans"
ii	"used in lieu of wages" means…	**C as a substitute**	chocolate was used instead of wages
iii	100 beans could buy a turkey hen — what does this tell us about a cacao bean's value?	**D**	a single bean had a small value (one bean = one tamale), so beans were likely used for everyday small purchases
iv	The genre of this essay is…	**B expository**	it informs and explains using facts, history and quotations
v	The invention of the steam engine…	**A**	made mass production of chocolate possible (it stopped being only for the rich)

2025 B-Q1(b)(i) **Alexandra Leaf said, "I often call chocolate the best-known food that nobody knows anything about." Defend the statement with TWO relevant points. [5]**

Everybody knows chocolate as a sweet bar or bonbon, but few know its real story. Firstly, for about ninety per cent of its history it was a bitter drink, and sugar had nothing to do with it. Secondly, people do not know that cacao beans were once money, that the word comes from the Aztec "xocoatl", or that "cacao", "cocoa" and "chocolate" mean different things.

≈ 65 words

2025 B-Q1(b)(ii) **As the Marketing Manager for Cadbury in England, compose a 60-word advertisement to promote Cadbury's latest chocolate product. [5]**

CADBURY CARAMEL CRUNCH — Taste the Joy!

Unwrap a moment of pure delight! New Cadbury Caramel Crunch wraps silky milk chocolate around golden caramel and crisp biscuit pieces. Made with the same Cadbury quality that families have loved since 1868, it is perfect for sharing, gifting or enjoying alone. Grab a bar today at your nearest shop. Cadbury Caramel Crunch — every bite is a celebration!

≈ 58 words

An advertisement needs: **catchy headline**, product name, 2–3 attractive features, a **call to action** (buy today), and a slogan.

2025 B-Q2(a) **The essay claims that the US chocolate manufacturing sector is worth more than $4 billion. Select a product from Bhutan and describe its potential and profitability similar to that of chocolate. [10]**

A product from Bhutan with great potential and profit is hydropower electricity.

Bhutan has fast, glacier-fed rivers and steep valleys, which are ideal for producing electricity. The energy is clean and renewable, and neighbouring India needs a large amount of power for its homes and industries. This gives Bhutan a ready and growing market, just as chocolate found markets across Europe and America.

Hydropower is also highly profitable. It is the biggest source of Bhutan's export income and government revenue, and once a plant is built it earns money for many years at low running cost. It creates jobs for engineers, technicians and construction workers, and it helps the nation to build roads, schools and hospitals.

However, like chocolate in the early days, it needs investment and careful management, and it depends on rainfall and snowmelt. With proper planning, hydropower can make Bhutan as prosperous as chocolate made its industry in the United States.

≈ 154 words

You can choose another product, for example **cardamom, Bhutanese apples, organic honey or handwoven textiles**. Keep the same three-part plan: **potential → profitability → challenges/conclusion**.

2025 B-Q2(b) Compare your own views and understanding of chocolate with the information presented in the essay. [10]

Before reading the essay, I thought of chocolate only as a sweet treat that is eaten as a bar, shared at festivals and given as a gift. I believed that it had always been a sugary food made in factories.

The essay changed my understanding. It shows that for most of its history chocolate was a bitter drink called xocoatl, and that sugar was added only after the Spanish took it to Europe. I also learned that cacao beans were once used as money, that the steam engine made mass production possible, and that the chocolate industry in America is worth billions of dollars.

My view and the essay agree on one point: chocolate is loved by everyone and is closely linked with enjoyment and celebration. However, I had seen it only as a simple pleasure, whereas the essay presents it as a food with a long history, great economic value and cultural importance. I now look at every bar with greater respect.

≈ 163 words

Chapter 7: Poem — Good Timber (Douglas Malloch)

Section C · asked in 2024 · a didactic (teaching) poem with an extended metaphor

7.1 The poem

Stanza 1
The tree that never had to fight
For sun and sky and air and light,
But stood out in the open plain
And always got its share of rain,
Never became a forest king
But lived and died a scrubby thing.

Stanza 2
The man who never had to toil
To gain and farm his patch of soil,
Who never had to win his share
Of sun and sky and light and air,
Never became a manly man
But lived and died as he began.

Stanza 3
Good timber does not grow with ease,
The stronger wind, the stronger trees,
The further sky, the greater length,
The more the storm, the more the strength.
By sun and cold, by rain and snow,
In trees and men good timbers grow.

Stanza 4
Where thickest lies the forest growth
We find the patriarchs of both.
And they hold counsel with the stars
Whose broken branches show the scars
Of many winds and much of strife.
This is the common law of life.

7.2 Must-know summary

Aspect	Details
Poet & form	Douglas Malloch (American poet, 1877–1938), the "lumberman's poet". Four stanzas of six lines each, rhymed in **couplets**: **AABBCC** in every stanza (fight/light, plain/rain, king/thing).
Central idea	**Struggle makes strength.** A tree (and a person) that grows without hardship stays small and ordinary; one that faces storms becomes strong, tall and wise.
Stanza 1	A tree that never had to fight for light and air, standing safe in an open plain with enough rain, never becomes a "forest king" — it stays a stunted "scrubby thing".
Stanza 2	The same is true of a man: one who never had to work hard for his land or share never becomes a "manly man"; he ends life exactly as he began.
Stanza 3	The key stanza: good timber grows through hardship — "the stronger wind, the stronger trees"; "the more the storm, the more the strength". Both trees and men grow strong through sun, cold, rain and snow.
Stanza 4	The finest, oldest trees (and men) are found where the forest is **thickest**, i.e. where competition is greatest. Their scars show many winds and struggles. "This is the common law of life."
Tone & mood	Encouraging, instructive, optimistic and reflective; the mood is inspiring and hopeful.
Symbols	**tree** = a person • **open plain** = comfort/easy life • **thick forest** = competition and challenge • **wind, storm** = difficulties in life • **scars** = experience and lessons from hardship • **patriarchs** = great, wise elders • **stars** = wisdom/high aspirations.
Devices	**Extended metaphor** (tree = man); **parallelism / anaphora** ("The stronger… the stronger…; the more… the more…"); **personification** ("hold counsel with the stars"); **imagery** (broken branches, scars); **alliteration** ("sun and sky", "stronger… storm… strength"); **repetition** ("sun and sky and light and air"); **contrast** between easy and hard growth; **aphorism** ("This is the common law of life").
Message	Do not fear challenges; they build character, strength and wisdom.

TREE ON THE OPEN PLAIN (comfort)		TREE IN THE THICK FOREST (struggle)
Never had to fight for light	→	Fights for sun, sky, air and light
Always gets rain and sun	→	Faces wind, cold, rain and snow
No storms to test it	→	Grows stronger with each storm
Stays a "scrubby thing"	→	Becomes a "forest king"
Lives and dies as it began	→	Wears scars that show its strength

Fig 7.1 The two trees in the poem (and two kinds of people)

STANZA 1 AABBCC

- fight - light
- plain - rain
- king - thing
- idea: comfort = weakness

STANZA 2 AABBCC

- toil - soil
- share - air
- man - began
- idea: same for men

STANZA 3 AABBCC

- ease - trees
- length - strength
- snow - grow
- idea: hardship = strength

STANZA 4 AABBCC

- growth - both
- stars - scars
- strife - life
- idea: scars = wisdom

Fig 7.2 Rhyme scheme and key words of each stanza

7.3 Exam link

Question	Type	Topic
2024 C-Q1(a)	5 MCQs	metaphor stanza; what the poem suggests; rhyme scheme; tone; symbolism of wind and storm
2024 C-Q1(b)(i)	60 words	How a person achieves true potential (with examples from the text)
2024 C-Q1(b)(ii)	60 words	If you were a tree — TWO ways to be strong and good (linked to a tree's characteristics)
2024 C-Q2	150 words	(a) the poet's purpose — TWO evidences OR (b) how a person's life is similar to/different from the tree in stanza 1

7.4 Solved questions

2024 C-Q1(a) MCQs [5]

No.	Question	Answer	Reason
i	The stanza that contains a metaphor on *growth and strength* is…	**C stanza 3**	"Good timber does not grow with ease… the more the storm, the more the strength" compares trees and men's growth
ii	What does the poem suggest about the growth of a good timber?	**B**	It grows stronger by facing challenges
iii	The rhyming scheme of the poem is…	**D AABBCC**	every stanza rhymes in couplets: fight/light, plain/rain, king/thing
iv	The tone of the poem is…	**C optimistic**	It encourages the reader and ends with a hopeful message (the poet also reflects on life, so "reflective" is close, but the closing message of strength is optimistic)
v	The natural elements wind and storm symbolize…	**C**	difficulties in life

2024 C-Q1(b)(i) According to the poem, how can a person achieve his/her true potential in life? Explain with examples from the text. [5]

According to the poem, a person achieves his true potential by facing hardship and working hard. The poet says that "good timber does not grow with ease" and "the more the storm, the more the strength". The tree that grows in the thick forest and fights for light becomes a forest king, while the man who never toils "lived and died as he began". Therefore, challenges build strength and greatness.

≈ 70 words

2024 C-Q1(b)(ii) If you were a tree, how would you project yourself to be a strong and good one? Mention any TWO ways linked to the characteristics of a tree. [5]

If I were a tree, I would first grow deep roots. Like roots, strong values, discipline and education would keep me steady when storms of failure or bad influence come. Secondly, I would keep growing towards the light and give shade and fruit to others. In the same way, I would keep learning and use my talents to help my community.

≈ 61 words

2024 C-Q2(a) What do you think is the poet's purpose of writing this poem? Justify with TWO evidences from the poem. [10]

In my opinion, the poet's purpose is to motivate people to accept hardship as the path to strength and greatness. He wants readers to see difficulties not as punishment but as training for life.

The first evidence is in stanza 3: "The stronger wind, the stronger trees… The more the storm, the more the strength." These parallel lines show that the greater the challenge, the stronger a tree, and in the same way a human, becomes.

The second evidence is in stanzas 1 and 2. The tree that "never had to fight" and the man who "never had to toil" end up as "a scrubby thing" and a person who "lived and died as he began". The poet uses these negative examples to warn that an easy life produces no growth.

Finally, stanza 4 says that scars show "many winds and much of strife" and calls this "the common law of life". Thus, the poem urges us to face struggles with courage.

≈ 162 words

2024 C-Q2(b) How is a person's life similar to or different from the tree mentioned in the first stanza? Justify your stand with reference to the poem. [10]

A person's life is similar to the tree in the first stanza in one way but different in another.

It is similar because both need struggle to grow. The tree on the open plain "never had to fight" for sun, sky, air and light, and it remained "a scrubby thing". In stanza 2 the poet says the man who never had to toil "lived and died as he began". So a person who avoids effort and lives a comfortable life also stays small and achieves nothing.

It is different because a human being can choose and learn, but a tree cannot. A tree has to grow where its seed falls, but a person can leave comfort, take up challenges and change his own destiny. A tree's growth is also only physical, whereas a person grows in character, wisdom and courage, as the "scars" in stanza 4 suggest.

Therefore, a person's life resembles the tree only if he chooses an easy path.

≈ 161 words

Chapter 8: Poem — To My Mother (George Barker)

Section C · asked in 2025 · a sonnet of praise and love

8.1 Must-know summary

Aspect	Details
Poet & form	George Barker (English poet, 1913–1991). A **sonnet** of 14 lines, printed as **8 lines + 6 lines**. The mother in the poem has an "Irish hand" (Irish roots) and the "bomber" shows it is set in wartime Britain (WWII).
Speaker & subject	A loving son speaks about his mother, who is both "most near" (in love) and "most far" (distant in time/space or perhaps dead).
Lines 1–8 (octave)	The son's picture of his mother: sitting by the window, **huge as Asia**, shaking with laughter, enjoying **gin and chicken**, as funny as the writer Rabelais yet most **tender towards weak creatures** (lame dogs, hurt birds). She is such a magnificent "procession" that others can only follow behind her like a small dog behind a brass band.
Lines 9–14 (sestet)	Her **courage and calm in war**: she will not look up at the bomber or run to a cellar, but stays like a **mountain** "whom only faith can move". The poet sends all his **faith and love** to tell her she will **move from "mourning" into "morning"** — from grief to hope.
Mood & tone	Affectionate, admiring, tender, warm and humorous; the mood is nostalgic and loving, ending in hope.
Themes	love and gratitude for a mother • strength, humour and warmth of a mother • compassion for the weak • courage and faith in difficult times • hope after grief.
Rhyme (slant)	Octave: far/for, found her/surround her, laughter/after, hand/band = **ABCDABCD**. Sestet: condescend/send, cellar/her, mountain/morning = **EFGEFG**.

Figures of speech (very important)

Device	Example	Effect
Oxymoron / paradox	"Most near, most dear, most loved and most far"	shows closeness in love but distance (in time, space or death)
Simile	"as huge as Asia"; "like a little dog following a brass band"; "like a mountain"	makes the mother look huge, grand and unmovable; humour
Metaphor / hyperbole	"seismic with laughter"; "She is a procession"	her laughter shakes like an earthquake; her personality is so grand that others follow her
Allusion	"Rabelais" (a French writer famous for earthy humour); mountain "whom only faith can move" (the Bible: faith can move mountains)	adds richness: wit and unshakeable strength
Pun / wordplay	"mourning" / "morning" (almost the same sound)	moves from grief to a new day of hope
Imagery	"Gin and chicken helpless in her Irish hand"; "the mahogany table"	vivid picture of a homely, joyful woman
Alliteration & repetition	"most near, most dear, most loved, most far"; "all my faith, and all my love"	rhythm and emotion
Apostrophe	"O all my faith, and all my love"	an emotional outburst, direct address

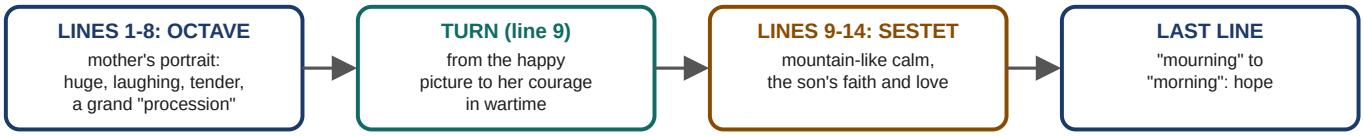


Fig 8.1 Structure of the sonnet

Features of a sonnet	In "To My Mother"
14 lines	8 + 6 lines
Two parts (octave + sestet) with a **turn (volta)**	Turn at "She will not glance up at the bomber…" (line 9) — from praise to courage and faith
Fixed, interlocking rhyme scheme	ABCDABCD EFGEFG (Petrarchan-style, with slant rhymes)
Regular line length (about ten syllables / iambic pentameter)	Most lines are about ten syllables long
One central idea, often love or praise, resolved at the end	Love and admiration for the mother; ends with a hopeful promise

8.2 Exam link

Question	Type	Topic
2025 C-Q1(a)	5 MCQs	mood; "Most near… most far"; "gin and chicken"; mother's laughter; "mourning to morning"
2025 C-Q1(b)(i)	60 words	Explain stanza 1 in your own words
2025 C-Q1(b)(ii)	60 words	TWO themes and how to apply them to relationships
2025 C-Q2	150 words	(a) FOUR features of a sonnet OR (b) FOUR figures of speech

8.3 Solved questions

2025 C-Q1(a) MCQs [5]

No.	Question	Answer	Reason
i	The general mood of the poem is…	**D nostalgic**	the son remembers and praises his mother with warm affection
ii	Figure of speech in "Most near… and most far"	**B oxymoron**	near and far are opposites placed together
iii	"gin and chicken helpless in her Irish hand" implies that the mother…	**B**	enjoys simple pleasures (she loves food and drink)
iv	The speaker describes his mother's laughter as…	**C seismic**	"seismic with laughter" — shaking like an earthquake
v	"…will move from mourning to morning" shows a shift from…	**C grief to hope**	mourning = grief; morning = a new day, hope

2025 C-Q1(b)(i) Explain the first stanza of the poem in your own words. [5]

The speaker addresses his mother as the person nearest to his heart, yet far from him now. He remembers finding her by the window, huge and shaking with laughter, enjoying gin and chicken. She was as witty as Rabelais but very gentle with injured dogs and birds. She was such a grand personality that everyone else could only follow her humbly, like a small dog behind a brass band.

≈ 69 words

2025 C-Q1(b)(ii) List any TWO possible themes from the poem and explain how you can apply them to make your relationship better with people around you. [5]

Two themes are love and gratitude towards parents, and compassion for the weak. To apply the first, I would spend time with my parents, help at home and say thank you often. To apply the second, I would treat classmates and neighbours kindly, especially those who are weak or in trouble. These habits would build trust and warm relationships.

≈ 59 words

2025 C-Q2(a) The poem "To My Mother" is a sonnet. List any FOUR features of sonnet used in the poem and explain. [10]

A sonnet is a fourteen-line poem about a single idea. "To My Mother" shows four features of the form.

First, it has fourteen lines, printed as eight lines followed by six. Second, it is divided into an octave and a sestet. The octave (lines 1–8) paints the portrait of the mother, while the sestet (lines 9–14) deals with her courage and the son's faith. Third, there is a turn (volta) at line 9, "She will not glance up at the bomber", where the poem moves from a happy picture to her courage during war. Fourth, it follows a fixed rhyme pattern, ABCDABCD EFGEFG, using slant rhymes such as far/for, laughter/after and mountain/morning.

Finally, like a traditional sonnet, the poem develops one idea, love and admiration for the mother, and closes with a resolution: she will "move from mourning into morning".

≈ 145 words

2025 C-Q2(b) List any FOUR figures of speech used in the poem and explain how each contributes in conveying the messages effectively. [10]

The poet uses several figures of speech to show his love and admiration.

First, the oxymoron "most near… and most far" shows that the mother is close to his heart but distant, which creates a feeling of longing. Second, similes such as "as huge as Asia" and "like a mountain" make her appear large-hearted, powerful and unshakeable. Third, the metaphor "seismic with laughter" compares her laughter to an earthquake, showing her lively, joyful nature. Fourth, the allusion to Rabelais and to faith moving mountains tells us that she is witty and strong in faith. The apostrophe "O all my faith, and all my love" shows his deep emotion, and it also shows that she faces life with humour and courage.

The wordplay on "mourning" and "morning" in the last line carries the central message of hope. Together, these devices make the portrait vivid and the emotions deeply felt.

≈ 148 words

Chapter 9: The Giver — Lois Lowry

Section D · asked in BOTH 2024 and 2025 · dystopian science-fiction novel (1993)

9.1 Must-know summary

Element	Details
Author & genre	Lois Lowry, American author. *The Giver* (1993) won the Newbery Medal. Genre: **dystopian science fiction** for young adults — a society that looks perfect but hides a terrible cost.
Setting	A future community controlled by **Sameness**: no colour (as people see it), no weather, hills or snow, no pain, no choice. Time: the days before and after the Ceremony of Twelve in December. Beyond the community lies "**Elsewhere**".
Point of view	**Third-person limited**: we see events through Jonas's thoughts and feelings only — this makes us share his confusion, fear and discoveries.
Main characters	**Jonas** — 11 turning 12, thoughtful, pale-eyed, chosen as the **Receiver of Memory**. **The Giver** — the old Receiver who holds all memories; wise, sad and lonely. **Father** (a Nurturer) and **Mother** (Department of Justice), sister **Lily**. **Asher** (friend, playful) and **Fiona** (friend, red hair). **Gabriel** (Gabe) — a baby with pale eyes who sleeps badly. **The Chief Elder** — leader who announces the assignments. **Rosemary** — the earlier Receiver-in-training who asked for Release.
Plot in brief	Jonas is anxious about the December Ceremony. He is selected as the **Receiver**, the one person who keeps the community's memories. The Giver transmits memories: snow, sled, sunshine, colour, love, joy — and pain, war and death. Jonas learns that **"Release"** means **killing**: he sees his own father release a baby twin. Gabriel is to be released, so Jonas decides to escape with him. Their journey is cold and hungry; at the end they reach a hill with snow and a sled and see a house with lights and hear music — **an open ending**.
Themes	**freedom and choice vs control** • **memory, pain and joy** — true humanity needs both • **individuality vs Sameness** • **love and relationships** • **cost of a "perfect" society** • courage and sacrifice.

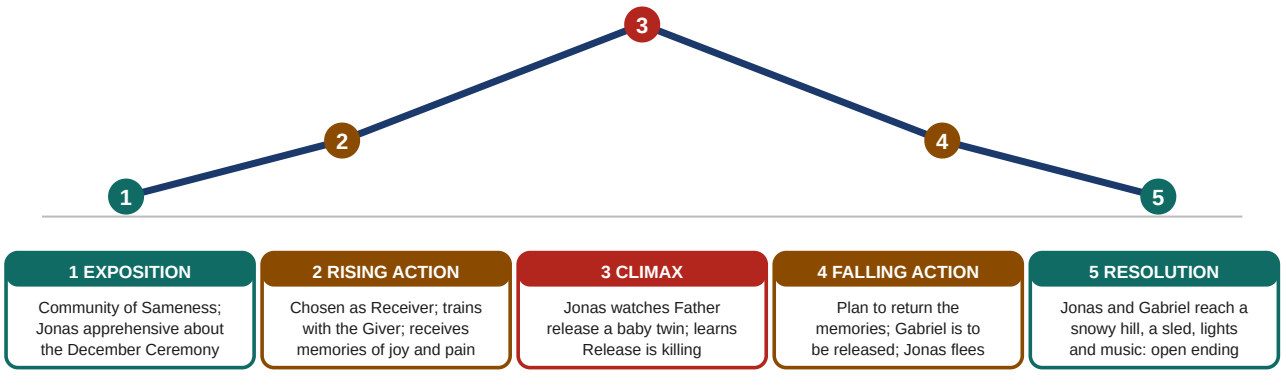


Fig 9.1 Plot diagram of The Giver

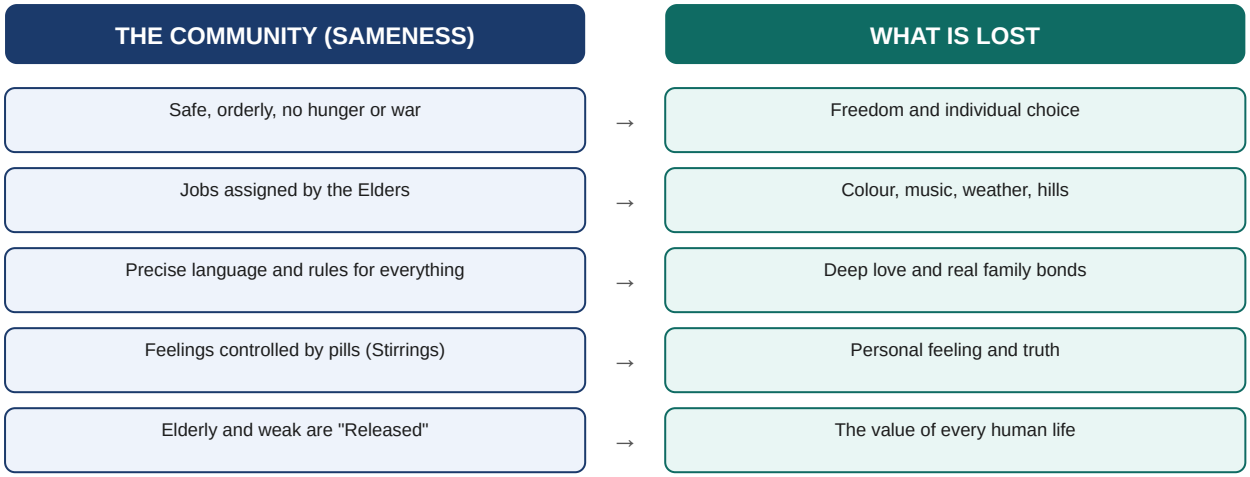


Fig 9.2 Life in Jonas's community and what it lacks

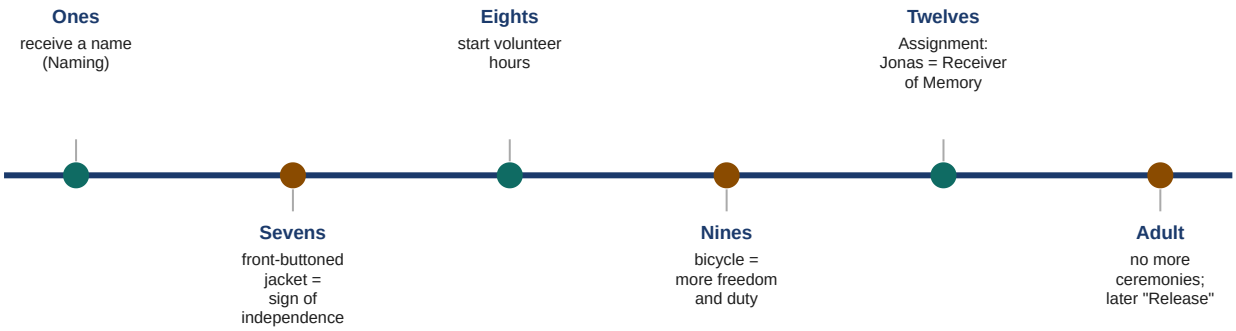


Fig 9.3 Ceremonies of growing up in the community

9.2 Key terms of the community

Term	Meaning
Sameness	The community's system: everyone is alike, all differences and strong feelings are removed to avoid conflict and pain.
Receiver of Memory / **The Giver**	The one person who holds the memories of the past. The Receiver is trained by the Giver and advises the Elders.
Assignment	The job given by the Committee of Elders at the Ceremony of Twelve, based on observation of each child.
Release	A polite word for **killing** (by injection). Used for the old, the weak, rule-breakers and some newchildren.
Elsewhere	The place outside the community where released people are said to go.
Stirrings	The first signs of adult feelings, suppressed daily with pills.
Precise language	The rule to use the exact word and avoid emotion (e.g. *apprehensive* not *frightened*).
Family unit	Two adults (a couple matched by the Committee) and two children (one boy, one girl); not a natural family.
Seeing beyond	Jonas's ability to see something that others cannot (first sign: the apple changes; later, colours).

9.3 Story in five phases (chapter numbers are approximate — match them with your book)

Phase	Main events	Why it matters
1. The community (Ch 1–6)	Jonas is apprehensive about December; evening ritual of telling feelings; Lily, Asher, Fiona; Jonas notices the apple "change" while playing catch; Gabriel stays with the family; the Release of an old man is celebrated.	Introduces Sameness; **foreshadows** his special gift and the secret of Release
2. The ceremony (Ch 7–8)	Ceremony of Twelve: Jonas's number is skipped; he is announced as the **Receiver of Memory**; the crowd is silent and uneasy.	Turning point: he is set apart from everyone
3. Training (Ch 9–16)	Jonas meets the Giver; first memory of snow and sled; sunshine; colours; pain (sunburn), war and death; the Giver explains why the community gave up memory; Jonas gains the ability to see colour and begins to feel love for his friends.	Jonas learns the value of feeling and the cost of Sameness
4. The truth (Ch 17–20)	Jonas asks about Rosemary and Release; he watches a video of his father releasing a baby twin; Jonas is horrified; he refuses to go home ("I won't go home!"); he and the Giver plan to return the memories to the people; Gabriel is to be released.	**Climax**: Release = murder
5. The escape (Ch 21–23)	Jonas leaves at night with Gabriel on a bicycle; searches by planes; hunger, cold, fading memories; he reaches a snowy hill, a sled, then lights and music.	Hopeful but **open ending**

9.4 Symbols, foreshadowing and devices

Symbol / device	Meaning / example
The apple	Jonas sees it "change" — the first sign of his ability to see beyond; later linked with colour (red).
Colour (red)	feeling, passion, life; what the community has lost.
Sled, snow, hill	joy, freedom and the beauty hidden by Sameness; they also appear in the ending.
The river	the way out of the community — escape and freedom to Elsewhere.
Gabriel	innocence and hope for the future; Jonas risks his life to save him.
Pale eyes	a sign of the capacity to receive memories (Jonas, the Giver, Gabriel).
Foreshadowing	(1) Jonas's **apprehension** about December; (2) the **apple** changing; (3) Gabriel's pale eyes and sleeplessness; (4) the memory of **Christmas lights, music and a sled on a hill**, which returns in the ending; (5) the celebration of a Release before Jonas knows what it means.
Irony	"Release" means death; the "perfect" community is cruel; the Chief Elder says "Thank you for your childhood" as children become adults.
Imagery & sensory detail	description of snow, sunburn, war and the warmth of a family Christmas.

Why *The Giver* is science fiction (2024 Q2b)

Science-fiction element	Example from the novel
Future / advanced technology and control	Climate Control (no weather or snow), the speaker announcements, pills that remove Stirrings, planes, injections for Release, video screens.
A controlled (dystopian) society	The Committee of Elders chooses jobs, spouses and children; rules for language; Sameness removes choices.

Speculative scientific ideas	Memories transmitted by touch; people's inability to see colour; the "capacity to see beyond".
Social criticism	Warns about giving up freedom and feelings for safety.

9.5 Exam link

Question	Type	Topic
2024 D-Q1(a)	5 MCQs	front-buttoned jacket; "Thank you for your childhood"; Jonas's outburst; foreshadowing; the river
2024 D-Q1(b)	60 words × 2	advantages of an ordered society without family and love; do you like the ending?
2024 D-Q2	150 words	(a) THREE benefits if the novel's concept of choice is applied in our society OR (b) THREE elements of science fiction
2025 D-Q1(a)	5 MCQs	role of the Giver; if the Giver dies; third-person limited; Ceremony of Twelve; how love is prevented
2025 D-Q1(b)	60 words × 2	an example of foreshadowing; is "release" justifiable? (TWO reasons)
2025 D-Q2	150 words	(a) How "Sameness" affects Jonas's personal connections OR (b) how precise language instils control and obedience

9.6 Solved questions

2024 D-Q1(a) MCQs [5]

No.	Question	Answer	Reason
i	After the seventh year, children get a front-buttoned jacket to signify that they are…	C	becoming independent — a jacket that can be buttoned by oneself is the first sign of independence
ii	"Thank you for your childhood" means…	B	they will now enter the world of adults — childhood is over after the Ceremony of Twelve
iii	"I won't go home! You can't make me!" — what made Jonas react?	D	watching the video of a Release ceremony (his father releasing the baby twin)
iv	Which options are examples of foreshadowing? (I apprehension about December; II elephant killed for tusk; III the apple; IV Christmas lights)	B	I, III & IV hint at later events (his selection, his gift, and the ending with lights). The elephant memory teaches cruelty but does not predict a later event.
v	The river in the novel symbolizes…	A	escape and freedom to Elsewhere — the way out of the community

2024 D-Q1(b)(i) What would be the advantages of living in an ordered society without family and loving relationships? Suggest and explain any TWO. [5]

Firstly, such a society is safe and peaceful. Everyone follows the same rules, so there is no poverty, hunger, crime or war, as in Jonas's community. Secondly, without strong emotional bonds, people do not suffer grief, jealousy or heartbreak. Decisions about jobs and spouses are made by the Elders, so there is no competition or wrong choice and life is calm and predictable.

≈ 63 words

2024 D-Q1(b)(ii) Do you like the ending of the novel? Justify your stand with TWO reasons linked to ideas stated in the novel. [5]

Yes, I like the ending. Firstly, it is hopeful: Jonas and Gabriel reach a snowy hill, a sled, lights and music, which recall the warm memory of a family Christmas and suggest freedom and love. Secondly, the open ending lets readers imagine the future and shows Jonas's courage in risking everything to save Gabriel and return the memories to the people.

≈ 61 words

2024 D-Q2(a) The concept of individual choice in The Giver is different from the one we understand and practise in our society. Explain THREE benefits if the concept practised in the novel is applied in our society. [10]

In the novel, the Committee of Elders makes the important choices for everyone, such as jobs, spouses and family. If this concept were applied in our society, there could be three benefits.

First, every person would get a job that suits his or her abilities. Jonas is observed for years before he is made the Receiver, so nobody is unemployed or chooses a wrong career, and talent is used well.

Second, society would be orderly and safe. When people follow the same rules and nobody competes for wealth or power, there would be less crime, fewer accidents and less conflict, as in Jonas's community where there is no hunger or war.

Third, people would be free from stress and regret. Young people would not worry about choosing a career or a partner, and nobody would blame himself for a wrong decision. Life would be calmer and more predictable.

However, these benefits come at the cost of freedom and feelings.

≈ 159 words

2024 D-Q2(b) The novel "The Giver" can be classified as science fiction. Identify any THREE elements of science fiction and elaborate each with examples from the novel. [10]

Science fiction imagines a future world shaped by science and technology. The Giver has at least three such elements.

The first element is advanced technology and control of nature. The community has Climate Control, so there is no snow, rain or hills. People use pills to suppress "Stirrings", and the Release of the old and babies is done by an injection.

The second element is a controlled, dystopian society. The Committee of Elders decides jobs, spouses and children, and Sameness removes differences, colour and choice. What looks like a perfect community hides cruelty, because the "Release" is really killing.

The third element is speculative scientific ideas. The Giver transmits memories to Jonas through the touch of his hands, and Jonas gains the "capacity to see beyond", such as seeing the colour red in the apple.

These elements make the novel a warning about a future without freedom.

≈ 147 words

2025 D-Q1(a) **MCQs [5]**

No.	Question	Answer	Reason
i	The primary role of the Giver is to…	C	hold and pass on the community's memories (and advise the Elders when needed)
ii	What would likely happen to the memories if the Giver dies before passing them on?	C	They would return to the community: when a Receiver is lost (as when Rosemary was released), the memories are released back to the people
iii	The third-person limited point of view helps readers understand Jonas's feelings because…	D	it gives direct insight into Jonas's personal thoughts and emotions
iv	The Ceremony of Twelve signifies…	B	the beginning of adulthood — children receive their Assignments
v	The community prevents feelings of love by…	C	controlling emotions with medication (daily pills for Stirrings)

2025 D-Q1(b)(i) **Lowry's use of foreshadowing contributes to the development of the plot. Mention ONE example of foreshadowing from the novel and explain how it helps the readers in understanding the events better. [5]**

One example is the apple. While playing catch with Asher, Jonas notices the apple change, although he cannot explain it. This hints early that Jonas has a special ability to see beyond. When he is later chosen as the Receiver and starts seeing colour, readers understand that the apple was the first sign of his gift, so his selection feels logical rather than sudden.

≈ 64 words

2025 D-Q1(b)(ii) **"Needless to say, he will be released, the voice had said, followed by silence." Is the "release" system in Jonas's community justifiable? List and explain any TWO reasons. [5]**

No, the release system is not justifiable. Firstly, it is murder disguised by a polite word: Jonas sees his own father inject a baby twin, which violates the basic right to life. Secondly, the community uses it to remove the weak, the old and rule-breakers without telling people the truth, so people lose their freedom, dignity and compassion.

≈ 58 words

2025 D-Q2(a) **How does "Sameness" affect Jonas's ability to form personal connections in the community? Use examples from the novel to illustrate its impact on his relationships and his ability to connect deeply with others. [10]**

Sameness removes strong feelings and differences, so it makes deep connections almost impossible for Jonas.

In his family unit, the evening ritual of telling feelings is polite and shallow. When Jonas asks his parents whether they love him, they laugh and say that the word is meaningless and that he must use precise language. Because they cannot feel deeply, Jonas cannot share his thoughts with them.

His friends also cannot understand him. Asher and Fiona see no colour, so after Jonas starts seeing red he cannot share it, and he feels lonely and different. Even his feelings for Fiona are treated as "Stirrings" to be controlled with pills.

Only after Jonas receives memories does he know love, and he forms real bonds with the Giver and with Gabriel, whom he risks his life to save. Thus Sameness blocks personal connection, and memory restores it.

≈ 144 words

2025 D-Q2(b) **How is the use of precise language shown to instill control and obedience in the community? Support**

your points using evidence from the text. [10]

In Jonas's community, language is carefully controlled so that people cannot think or feel beyond the rules.

First, children are corrected whenever their words are not exact. Jonas is told that "frightened" is the wrong word and he should say "apprehensive", and he is told to avoid exaggerated words like "starving". This trains people to hide their feelings and to accept the system.

Second, harsh realities are hidden behind polite words. "Release" means killing, and "Elsewhere" hides the truth about where people go. Because the words sound gentle, nobody questions what happens.

Third, rules and announcements are communicated by a speaker, and everyone must reply politely with set phrases, such as apologising and accepting apologies. This produces habit and obedience rather than thought.

Thus precise language limits thought, emotion and rebellion.

≈ 131 words

Chapter 10: Literary Terms & Last-Minute Revision

English II — glossary, themes at a glance, and the one-page checklist

10.1 Glossary of literary terms (with examples from your texts)

Term	Meaning	Example
Simile	comparison using *like / as*	"like a mountain" (To My Mother)
Metaphor	direct comparison without *like/as*	"seismic with laughter"; the tree = man (Good Timber)
Personification	giving human qualities to non-human things	trees "hold counsel with the stars"
Hyperbole	deliberate exaggeration	"huge as Asia"
Oxymoron	two opposite words together	"most near… most far"
Irony	the opposite of what is expected	the "prisoner" wins (The Bet); the White Knight becomes the Black Knight
Foreshadowing	hints at later events	the apple, Christmas lights (The Giver)
Flashback	a scene from the past	the party fifteen years ago (The Bet)
Symbol	an object that stands for an idea	wind/storm = difficulties; crust = sharing
Allegory	a story with a hidden moral meaning	The White Knight
Allusion	reference to a known person, book or event	Rabelais; faith moves mountains
Alliteration	repetition of initial sounds	"sun and sky", "stronger… storm… strength"
Imagery	words that create pictures/senses	"broken branches show the scars"
Tone / **Mood**	writer's attitude / feeling created in the reader	optimistic tone (Good Timber); nostalgic mood (To My Mother)
Theme	central message	struggle builds strength; greed corrupts
Dramatic irony	reader knows more than the character	the labourer is really the imp
Point of view	the angle of narration	third-person limited (The Giver)
Dystopia	an imagined society that seems perfect but is harmful	Jonas's community
Rhyme scheme	pattern of end-rhymes (AABB…)	Good Timber: AABBCC
Sonnet / octave / sestet / volta	14-line poem / first 8 lines / last 6 lines / turn of thought	To My Mother

10.2 Themes at a glance

Text	Central theme	One key piece of evidence
The Bet	money is worthless against wisdom and moral freedom	the lawyer renounces two million and leaves early
The White Knight	appearances deceive; self-righteousness leads to evil	his armour turns black beside the white youth
The Imp and the Crust	wealth and vice corrupt a good man	the peasant refuses a drink to a poor man
The Titanic (essay)	human arrogance and ignored safety	lifeboats for 1200 of 3500 people

Chocolate (essay)	how a food acquired history, value and an industry	cacao beans used as currency
Good Timber	struggle makes strength	"the more the storm, the more the strength"
To My Mother	love, courage and hope	"move from mourning into morning"
The Giver	freedom, memory and feeling are essential to being human	"Release" is killing; Jonas escapes with Gabriel

10.3 Last-minute checklist

Before the exam

☐ Know the plot of each story in 5 sentences • ☐ Know each poem's theme, tone, 4 devices • ☐ Know *The Giver*'s 5 phases and 5 symbols • ☐ Practise one 60-word and one 150-word answer for each text • ☐ Revise the essay features (thesis, chronological vs cause-effect, report, advertisement).

In the exam

• Circle ONE letter per MCQ. • Answer every part of the question (e.g. "TWO reasons" = two). • Use evidence: a quotation or an event. • Present tense for literature. • Do not retell the whole story. • Respect the word limit: 60 words ≈ 4–5 lines; 150 words ≈ 10–12 lines.